

Q-1:

Define Qur'an literally & Terminologically. Write down the characteristics of Qur'an & explain some of them properly.

Ans:

The literal meanings of the holy Quran :

The word 'Quran' is a derivative from a root or proper noun.

If it is derivative from a root then

1. Qaraa- to recite
2. Qarana- to join
3. Qarain- to be like
4. Qarun- to combine

The terminological meaning of the holy Quran :

Terminologically Quran means the speech of Allah sent down (in Arabic language) upon the last prophet Muhammad (SAW) through angel Gabriel in its precise meanings and wordings (recorded in the manuscripts) transmitted to us by numerous persons both verbally and in writing.

Characteristics of the holy Quran :

1. Quran is the speech of Allah.
2. Quran is the greatest miracle.
3. Quran is protected from any change and alternation.
4. Quran is free from contradictions.
5. Quran has influential power.
6. Quran is beyond produce and mimicry.
7. Quran is easy to memorize.

Qur'an is the speech of Allah :

The holy Qur'an is the speech of Allah in Arabic language. It is not speech of Gabriel nor Mohammad (SAW). It was revealed to Prophet (SAW) through Gabriel over a period of twenty three years.

Allah (SWT) says : And indeed, the Qur'an is the revelation of the Lord of the worlds. The trustworthy Spirit (Gabriel) has brought it down. Upon your (Mohammad) heart that you may be of the warners. In a clear Arabic language. (Surah As-Shua'raa : 192-195)

Quran is the greatest miracle :

Allah (SWT) has sent many prophets with miracles as proof as

their prophet-hood. Muhammad (SAW) was also given many miracles and the Qur'an is the greatest of his miracles.

Allah (SWT) says : And they (disbelievers) say, " Why are not signs sent down to him from his

Lord? ". Say " The signs are only with Allah and I am only a clear warner ". Is it not sufficient for hem that We revealed to you the book which is recited to them?. Indeed in that is mercy and

reminder for the believers. (Surah Al-Ankabut : 50-51)

Q-2:

Write down various names & attribute names of Qur'an.

Ans:

The original names of the holy Quran :

1. Al-Kitaab- the scripture
2. Al-Furqan- the criterion

3. At-Tanzeel- the revelation

4. Ad-Dhikr- the reminder

The attribute names of the holy Quran :

1. Al-Huda

2. Al- Bushra

3. Al-Azeem

4. Al-Burhan

5. Al-Kareem

6. Al-Majeed

7. An-Nur

8. Al-Hakim

9. Al-Mubin

10. As-Shifa etc.

Q-3:

Define Wahi literally & terminologically. " The procedures & means of Wahi are different " evaluate this statement.

Ans:

The literal meaning of Wahi :

The word "Wahi" has two basic meaning.

1. Swiftiness

2. Secrecy

So Wahi means swift & secret transfer of information.

The terminological meaning :

Terminologically Wahi means the process by which the words of Allah or the actual words of Allah are spoken to any of His prophets.

Classification of Wahi :

Wahi may be revealed to the prophets in two ways.

1. Direct Wahi.

It can be two types.

(a) True dreams

(b) Direct conversation from behind a veil.

2. Indirect Wahi.

It can be two types.

(a) By way of the angel

(b) Reverberating like a sound of the gong of a bell.

These procedures of Wahi were identified by Allah in the Qur'an as follows : Allah (SWT) doesn't speak to a person except by Wahi or from behind a veil or by sending a messenger who then reveals by His permission whatever He wishes. Verily, He is most High & Wise. (Surah As-Shura : 51)

Means of Wahi :

Wahi has been used to indicate some meaning in the Qur'an.

1. Natural human instinct.
2. Intuition.
3. Instinctual animal habits.
4. Whispering & prodding of the devils.
5. Communication by rapid, subtle gestures.
6. Command of Allah to the nature.
7. Command of Allah to the angels.
8. Command of Allah to the messengers.

Q-4:

What are the stages of revelation of Qur'an. Explain wisdom behind gradual revelation of Qur'an.

Ans:

There are three stages of revelation of Qur'an.

1. First Stage : The Qur'an was written on the Lauh Mahfoodh (The preserved Tablet) which is with Allah. But how & when it was written is known only to Allah. He says in this regard : Nay! This is indeed a glorious Qur'an. (Inscribed) in the Lauh Mahfoodh. (Surah Al-Burooj : 21-22)

2. Second Stage : From Lauh Mahfoodh, Allah revealed the whole Qur'an to the heaven closer to earth, in a place called Baitul Izzah (The House of Honor) on the Night of Decree. The Qur'an states : The month of Ramadan is the month in which the Qur'an was revealed... (Surah Al Baqarah : 185).

It also states : We revealed it on a blessed night. (Surah Ad-Dukhan : 3)

3. Third Stage : This is last stage of revelation of Qur'an. The angel Gabriel brought it to the Prophet (SAW) in piecemeal fashion catering the needs of human beings.

And indeed, the Qur'an is the revelation of the Lord of the worlds. The Trustworthy Spirit has brought it down Upon your (Mohammad) heart that you may be of the warners. In a clear Arabic language. (Surah Ash Shua'ra, 192-195)

Wisdom behind gradual revelation of Qur'an :

1. To strengthen the resolve of the prophet : And those who disbelieve say, "Why was the Qur'an not revealed to him all at once?" Thus [it is] that We may strengthen thereby your heart.

And We have spaced it distinctly. (Surah Al-Furqan :32)

2. To make easy memorization & understanding of Qur'an : The piecemeal revelation of Qur'an made it easier for the Companions to understand, memorize & implement the portions that were revealed. If the Qur'an had been revealed all at once it might have been difficult for them.

3. To prove the truthfulness of Prophet (SAW) : Whenever a situation or crisis arose, Qur'an would clearly lay out the situation. It would prove that he is a true messenger.

4. To prove the miraculous nature of Qur'an : If Qur'an is not from Allah there might have contradiction between verses of Qur'an.

5. To reveal the laws of Islam in gradual manner : The piecemeal revelation of Islamic laws made easier for the Companions to adopt these.

6. To ease the revelation process on the Prophet (SAW) : The

process of Wahi was difficult for the Prophet (SAW). Had the Qur'an been revealed all at once it might have been too difficult for him (SAW) to bear.

Q-5:

Define Ayah & Surah. Describe the arrangement of Ayah & Surah with the opinions of Islamic scholars.

Ans:

Ayah/Verse :

Literally Ayah means sign, indication, miracle, admonition & sentence etc.

Terminologically Ayah means part of Qur'an composed of sequential letters & words separated from what is before it & after it with a beginning & an ending occupying a place in a specific surah.

Arrangement of the verses :

Even though there are different opinions over the actual numbers of verse. There is no different opinion over the fact that the arrangement & order of verses in each surah is from the prophet himself. The prophet used to mention to the scribe the verse where to put the verse in the surah of Qur'an. He didn't use to do this by his own judgement, for Gabriel uses to tell him and he was inspired by Allah (SWT) with this knowledge.

Uthmaan Ibn Abi-Al-Aas (R) reported that he was sitting by the Prophet (SAW) when he notices that the Prophet raised his eyes and fixed his gaze, he (SAW) said " Gabriel came to me and comanded me to put this verse at a certain point in the surah ".

Surah :

Literally surah means enclosure, fencing, wall & elevated place etc.

Terminologically means a specific group of verses arranged in a specific manner closed to its inhabitants.

Arrangement of the surahs :

There are three opinions about the arrangement of the surahs.

1. The arrangement of the surahs was from the ijtihaad of the Companions specially Zayd Bin Thabit (R), not from the Prophet. This is the opinion of Imam Maalik and Abu Bakr Al-Baaqillanee (Rh). The proof that is given for this opinion is the fact that Companions had different arrangement of the surahs in their respective manuscripts. such as Ali, Ubay Bin Ka'ab, Ibn Mas'ood's (R) manuscripts.

2. The arrangement of the surahs was done by the Prophet (SAW) and some part by the ijtihaad of the Companions. There are also different opinions among the holders of this opinion that how many surahs were arranged by the Prophet & by the Companions. The most common opinion among them is that all the surah were arranged by the Prophet except for Surah At-Tawbah & Al-Anfaal.

As proof they use a hadith of Ibn Abbas (R) that he asked

Uthmaan (R) " Why did you pair Al-Anfaal, even though it is from madani surah with At-Tawbah which is from mi'een surah. And why didn't you write the basmalah between them and put both of them in the tiwaal surahs "

Uthmaan (R) answered " The surahs were or something was revealed to the Prophet (SAW) he would call a scribe and tell him to put this verse in the surahs in which such & such is mentioned. Because of similarity of this two surahs thought that it was part of it. The Prophet (SAW) passed away before I could ask him concerning this issue. So I put the two of these together ".

This is the opinion of Imam As-Suyoote.

3. The whole arrangement of the surahs was from the Prophet (SAW). This is the strongest opinion among three opinions. Because ijtihaad of first opinion is weak for being manuscripts in chronological order. The hadith of second opinion is so weak that it can't be used as proof the matter.

The proof that is given for third opinion is that the Prophet (SAW) used to recite the surah to the Companions in a specific order and he mentioned the order of some surah

in certain hadith. For example, he said " Recite the two bright ones : Al-Baqarah & Aali- Imraan ".

Solved by Pirate-3168 (3EM)